

Little Believers Tigrinya Bible Stories

Joseph's Colorful Coat

Hburan Klbsi Yosef

A Bilingual Bible Story

klte-quanqua nay metsHaf qddus zanta

Book 6 of 20

Ages 3-10

For every child who has known hurt but still chooses forgiveness

nkulu qolA gidAt zfleTe gn yqret zmrits

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[PICTURE: A warm watercolor children's Bible illustration of a large family in ancient times. Father Jacob, an elderly man with East African/Eritrean features and a white beard, sits surrounded by his twelve sons of various ages. Young Joseph, about seventeen, sits closest to his father with a bright, happy smile. The family is gathered under a tent with sheep grazing nearby. Golden afternoon light creates a warm family scene.]

ENGLISH:

Long ago, there lived a man named Jacob who had twelve sons! Jacob loved all his children, but he had a very special love for his son Joseph. Joseph was kind, good, and always tried to do what was right. Joseph loved God and God had big plans for him.

TIGRINYA:

Ab qedem, Hade sebAy Yaaqob zstsmA AsrteKlte Awlad znberwu neyru! Yaaqob nkulu deqyu yfetwm neyru, gn nwdu Yosef bflay fqri neyrwu. Yosef Hyanet, TsbuQ, n kulu gize TsbuQ kmgbar zdeleye neyru. Yosef nAmlak yfetwu n Amlak Abi mdhani nebru.

(Pronunciation: Yaaqob = Jacob, Yosef = Joseph, Awlad = sons)

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[PICTURE: A vibrant watercolor children's Bible illustration of Jacob presenting a beautiful, colorful coat to young Joseph. The coat has every color of the rainbow — red, blue, purple, gold, green — with beautiful patterns. Joseph's eyes light up with joy and surprise. He holds the coat up in wonder. Jacob smiles lovingly. The coat is the most colorful thing in the scene — it practically glows. East African/Eritrean features on both.]

ENGLISH:

One day, Jacob gave Joseph a very special gift — a beautiful coat of many colors! It had red, blue, purple, gold, and green. No one else had a coat like it! Joseph was so happy. He wore it proudly everywhere he went. It showed how much his father loved him.

TIGRINYA:

Hade meAlti, Yaaqob nYosef bhwti bflay wuhal Habwu — mrmr Hburan klbsi! Qeyh, smayawi, Halmay, wereqawi, n Imulimu nebru. Kaleet Hade sebAy kmslu klbsi AynebronN! Yosef bhwti Hagisu. BHbri kab'ta lebisyu Ab zmKontu keydu. Abuuu knday kftewr yrAi neyru.

(Pronunciation: Hburan = colorful, klbsi = coat, Qeyh = red, smayawi = blue)

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[PICTURE: A watercolor children's Bible illustration of Joseph's older brothers watching him wear his colorful coat. Their faces show jealousy and anger — frowns, crossed arms, sideways glances. Joseph happily helps his father, unaware of their feelings. The brothers huddle in a group whispering. Their dark, shadowy colors contrast with Joseph's bright, colorful coat. The divide between them is visible. East African/Eritrean features on all.]

ENGLISH:

But Joseph's older brothers became very jealous! "Why does Father love Joseph more than us?" they grumbled. "Look at that fancy coat! He thinks he is better than us!" Their hearts were full of anger and jealousy. They could not even say a kind word to Joseph.

TIGRINYA:

Gn AEwdu AHwat Yosef bhwti QnA'om! "Slemntay Ab'yna nYosef kAbna yAbll yfetwu?" belu. "Netya tsebQti klbsi! Kab'na yAbll zble ymsel!" Lbatom bQunAE n bHrage temeliEu. Hade Hyanet qal dk'A nYosef kmzblu AykelewN.

(Pronunciation: QnA'om = jealous, AHwat = brothers, Hrage = anger)

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[PICTURE: A watercolor children's Bible illustration of young Joseph sleeping peacefully in his bed with a dream shown above him in soft, glowing watercolors. In the dream, sheaves of wheat bow down to one standing sheaf. Stars and the sun and moon also bow. The dream images float in a dreamy golden light above sleeping Joseph. His colorful coat is folded neatly beside his bed. East African/Eritrean features.]

ENGLISH:

God gave Joseph special dreams! In one dream, Joseph saw bundles of wheat bowing down to his bundle. In another dream, the sun, moon, and eleven stars bowed to him! When Joseph told his brothers about the dreams, they became even more angry and jealous.

TIGRINYA:

Amlak nYosef bflay Hlmtat Habwu! Ab Hade Hlmi, Yosef gzfetat srnay
nay'u gzfet krAymAymu reAye. Ab kAlla Hlmi, tsHay, werHi, n
AsHadAsrte kewakbti sengesedwuyu! Yosef nAHwatu bzaEba Hlmtatu
mskngerom, btsgir QnA'om n Hrago'om.

(Pronunciation: Hlmtat = dreams, gzfetat = bundles of wheat, kewakbti = stars)

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[PICTURE: A watercolor children's Bible illustration of Joseph's brothers out in the fields with their sheep when they see Joseph walking toward them in the distance, his colorful coat bright against the dusty landscape. The brothers huddle together with wicked faces, making their evil plan. One points at approaching Joseph. The landscape is dry and lonely — far from home. Shadows fall across the scheming brothers. East African/Eritrean features.]

ENGLISH:

One day, Jacob sent Joseph to check on his brothers who were far away watching their sheep. When the brothers saw Joseph coming in his colorful coat, they made a terrible plan. "Here comes the dreamer!" they said. "Let us get rid of him!" Their hearts were very cruel.

TIGRINYA:

Hade meAlti, Yaaqob nYosef AHwatu rHuq qota begatatom kEqbu lesle'yu. AHwat nYosef Ab Hburan klbsu kmetse mskrAdyu, Asfokhay mdhani Amtsi'wom. "EnHu Halami ymetse Alo!" belu. "NwEdo!" LbatOm bhwti gwdAE neyru.

(Pronunciation: Halami = dreamer, nwEdo = let's get rid of him, gwdAE = cruel)

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[PICTURE: A dramatic watercolor children's Bible illustration showing the brothers grabbing Joseph roughly. They pull off his beautiful colorful coat, tearing it from his shoulders. Joseph's face shows shock and fear. The coat — so vibrant and beautiful — is crumpled on the ground. The brothers' faces are hard and mean. One brother (Reuben) in the back looks troubled and worried. A deep empty pit is visible nearby. East African/Eritrean features.]

ENGLISH:

When Joseph arrived, his brothers grabbed him! They ripped off his beautiful coat and threw him into a deep, dark pit. Poor Joseph cried and begged his brothers to let him out. But most of them did not listen. They sat down to eat their lunch while Joseph cried below.

TIGRINYA:

Yosef mskbetse, AHwatu Hazbwu! Mrmr klbsu meHizwom Ab Hade bguH tsllm gwaHi Adelewwu. Mskn Yosef binkyu AHwatu kHdgwu lemene. Gn AAbzaHatom Aysem'wuN. Yosef Ab tHti kbenky msdOwm kblu teqemiTom.

(Pronunciation: Hazbwu = grabbed him, gwaHi = pit, binkyu = he cried)

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[PICTURE: A watercolor children's Bible illustration showing a caravan of merchants with camels passing by on the dusty road. The merchants wear traveling clothes and their camels carry large bundles of goods. The brothers look at each other with a new terrible idea — to sell Joseph. One brother points at the caravan, another pulls Joseph from the pit. Coins exchange hands. Joseph looks confused and scared. East African/Eritrean features.]

ENGLISH:

Then traders came by on camels, heading to Egypt. The brothers had another terrible idea: they sold Joseph to the traders for twenty pieces of silver! Joseph was taken far, far away from his home and his father. His heart was breaking. How could his own brothers do this?

TIGRINYA:

Dhrzi negedti bGameltat nab Gbtsi ygAshshu mskmetsu. AHwat kalAy Asfokhay Hasab Amtsi'wom: nYosef nnegedti bAEsrte qershi brur sheTwu! Yosef kab geza n kab Ab'yu rHuq tewsd'e. Lbu ytsbyere neyru. AHwatu kndayday ezA kgbru kelewem?

(Pronunciation: negedti = traders, Gameltat = camels, qershi = silver, sheTwu = sold him)

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[PICTURE: A watercolor children's Bible illustration showing the brothers dipping Joseph's colorful coat in goat's blood and then presenting the ruined, bloody coat to their elderly father Jacob. Jacob's face crumbles with grief — he falls to his knees weeping. The brothers look guilty but maintain their lie. The beautiful coat is now stained and torn. The scene is deeply sad. Evening light makes everything somber. East African/Eritrean features.]

ENGLISH:

The wicked brothers dipped Joseph's coat in goat's blood and brought it to their father. "We found this," they lied. "Is it Joseph's coat?" Poor Jacob thought a wild animal had killed his beloved son. He wept and wept. His heart was shattered with grief.

TIGRINYA:

Hfuran AHwat nklbsi Yosef Ab dHmi FerH Halnisywom nab AbOm Amtsi'wom. "NezA redinka'yo," Hasewu. "Nay Yosef klbsi diya?" Mskn Yaaqob Adi Ensisa nFqur wdu kezA qetilwu bele. Binkyu n Binkyu. Lbu bHzni tsebyiru.

(Pronunciation: dHmi = blood, Hasewu = they lied, Binkyu = he wept)

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[PICTURE: A watercolor children's Bible illustration of Joseph arriving in Egypt — a grand city with pyramids and palm trees in the background. Joseph looks small and lonely among the busy Egyptian marketplace. He is sold again to a rich man named Potiphar. Despite his sadness, Joseph holds his head up. A faint golden glow around him shows God is still with him even here. Colorful Egyptian architecture surrounds the scene. East African/Eritrean features on Joseph.]

ENGLISH:

Joseph was taken all the way to Egypt and sold as a slave to a rich man named Potiphar. He was far from home, all alone, with no family. But even in this sad place, God was with Joseph! God never left his side, and Joseph never stopped trusting God.

TIGRINYA:

Yosef nmluE mdri Gbtsi tewsidu kmsla bAriya nHade habtam sebAy Potifar zstsmA tesheTe. Kab geza rHuq, brHuqu, blAsh sdra bet neyru. Gn dk'A Ab'za Hzin qota, Amlak msla Yosef neyru! Amlak ftstsum kab jAnbu AylAleyen, Yosef dk'A ftstsum Amlak AmmAmen AydeweN.

(Pronunciation: bAriya = slave, Gbtsi = Egypt, habtam = rich)

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[PICTURE: A watercolor children's Bible illustration showing Joseph working hard in Potiphar's house. He sweeps, organizes supplies, and manages other workers. His face shows determination and honesty. Potiphar watches from the background, impressed and pleased. Everything Joseph touches seems to prosper — flowers bloom brighter, shelves are organized perfectly. God's blessing is shown as golden sparkles around Joseph's work. East African/Eritrean features.]

ENGLISH:

Joseph worked very hard and was honest in everything he did. God blessed everything Joseph touched! Potiphar saw how special Joseph was and put him in charge of his whole house. Even as a slave, Joseph did his very best because he was working for God.

TIGRINYA:

Yosef bhwti tsibuq serihyu n Ab kulu tseduq neyru. Amlak kulu Yosef ztnKwu meRiQwu! Potifar kndayday bflay Yosef mKanu reAiyu Ab mluE gezu Halafy gebrwu. Dk'A kmsla bAriya, Yosef zAblllo gire kemey nAmlak ysryhu sle znebere.

(Pronunciation: tseduq = honest, meRiQwu = blessed it, Halafy = in charge)

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[PICTURE: A dark watercolor children's Bible illustration of Joseph being put in prison unfairly. He is led through a heavy stone doorway into a dim prison cell by Egyptian guards. His face is sad but not hopeless — he still looks upward as if talking to God. Prison bars cast shadows. Other prisoners sit in the dim background. Despite the darkness, a small ray of golden light follows Joseph. East African/Eritrean features.]

ENGLISH:

Then something very unfair happened — Joseph was put in prison even though he had done nothing wrong! It seemed like things just kept getting worse for poor Joseph. But even in the dark prison, God was still with him. Joseph kept praying and trusting God's plan.

TIGRINYA:

Dhrzi bhwti zAyFtuH nger tekewne — Yosef Ab qeed AtiywU dk'A Hade Hfur nger keAygberere! Ngeratat nMskn Yosef yelay n yelay Hfur kmsel jemere. Gn dk'A Ab tsllum qeed, Amlak gna mslu neyru. Yosef ktsly n mdhani Amlak kAmmen qetsele.

(Pronunciation: qeed = prison, zAyFtuH = unfair, kAmmen = to trust)

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[PICTURE: A watercolor children's Bible illustration of Joseph in prison interpreting the dreams of two fellow prisoners — a baker and a cup-bearer. Joseph sits between them, explaining their dreams with animated gestures. One prisoner looks hopeful, the other worried. A faint golden glow emanates from Joseph as God gives him wisdom. The prison is dark but Joseph's area seems brighter. East African/Eritrean features on Joseph.]

ENGLISH:

In prison, God gave Joseph the special gift of understanding dreams! Two prisoners — the king's baker and cup-bearer — had strange dreams. Joseph told them what the dreams meant, and everything came true exactly as Joseph said! God's gift was working through Joseph.

TIGRINYA:

Ab qeed, Amlak nYosef bflay wuhal Hlmtat krdA'e Habwu! Klte Esuran — HabAz n saqy nGuS — Astenkafy Hlmtat Halemwom. Yosef mntay mKan Hlmtato'wm nebirwom, n kulu nger kmsla Yosef zblo bqTtu tekewne! Wuhal Amlak bYosef yserH neyru.

(Pronunciation: Hlmtat = dreams, Esuran = prisoners, wuhal = gift)

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[PICTURE: A dramatic watercolor children's Bible illustration of Pharaoh (the king of Egypt) tossing and turning in his grand bed, unable to sleep. Above him, his troubling dreams appear in swirling watercolors — seven fat cows eaten by seven thin cows, and seven full wheat stalks swallowed by seven dry ones. The dream images are strange and scary. Pharaoh wakes up sweating and confused. The royal bedroom is lavish but dark with worry. East African/Eritrean features.]

ENGLISH:

Two whole years later, Pharaoh — the king of Egypt — had two strange and scary dreams that no one could explain! He dreamed of seven fat cows eaten by seven skinny cows, and seven fat wheat stalks swallowed by seven thin ones. The king was very troubled!

TIGRINYA:

Dhri klte mluA Amtat, Frown — nGuS Gbtsi — klte Astenkafy n Asfrahi
Hlmtat Hade sebAy kHntrwo zAykeI Halemel! ShbuE smunti LAHmtat
bshbuE zeAbat LAHmtat kblaA, n shbuE smunti srnay bshbuE dQaQ
ztHwelaw Halemel. NGuS bhwiti teseKefe!

(Pronunciation: Frown = Pharaoh, shbuE = seven, LAHmtat = cows, srnay = wheat)

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[PICTURE: A watercolor children's Bible illustration of Joseph — now older with a short beard but still with East African/Eritrean features — being brought from prison before Pharaoh's throne. Joseph has been cleaned up and given new clothes. He stands humbly but confidently before the great king. The throne room is magnificent with Egyptian columns and gold. Pharaoh leans forward eagerly. Guards and advisors fill the grand hall.]

ENGLISH:

The cup-bearer finally remembered Joseph! He told Pharaoh about the man in prison who could understand dreams. Pharaoh sent for Joseph immediately. Joseph stood before the king and said, "I cannot explain dreams by myself, but God will give you the answer."

TIGRINYA:

Saqy Ab mewedsAta nYosef Zekerewu! NFrown bzaEba Ab qeed Hlmtat krdAi zkEl sebAy neberwu. Frown bqTta nYosef Amtsi'wu. Yosef Ab qddmi nGuS dewe bele: "Bnatey Hlmtat kHntr Aykhleln, Gn Amlak nAkha mels kHb eyu."

(Pronunciation: Zekerewu = remembered him, mels = answer, Ab qddmi = before)

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[PICTURE: A watercolor children's Bible illustration of Joseph explaining Pharaoh's dreams to the king. Joseph uses his hands expressively — showing seven fingers, then making eating gestures. Pharaoh listens intently, nodding. Behind Joseph, faint watercolor images of fat cows and thin cows, fat wheat and thin wheat illustrate his words. Advisors take notes on scrolls. The scene shows wisdom and authority. East African/Eritrean features on Joseph.]

ENGLISH:

Joseph explained, "God is telling you what will happen! Seven years of plenty are coming — lots of food everywhere. But after that, seven years of terrible famine will come when nothing will grow. You must save food during the good years to survive the bad years!"

TIGRINYA:

Yosef Hntre: "Amlak mntay kmKwn mKanu ybreKa Alo! ShbuE Amtat bHfuret ymetsu — bluy meghbi Ab kulu qota. Gn dhri'zi, shbuE Amtat Asfrahi tsmi kmetsu kulu nger kemzAytbql. Ab TsbuQ Amtat meghbi ktzHaw Aleka nHfur Amtat kmtdHn!"

(Pronunciation: tsmi = famine, bHfuret = plenty, ktzHaw = to save)

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[PICTURE: A magnificent watercolor children's Bible illustration of Pharaoh placing a golden ring on Joseph's finger and a gold chain around his neck. Joseph now wears fine Egyptian royal clothes — white linen with gold. Pharaoh's face shows deep respect and trust. The court applauds. Joseph has gone from prisoner to the second most powerful man in Egypt in one day! Bright gold and white colors radiate power and honor. East African/Eritrean features on Joseph.]

ENGLISH:

Pharaoh was amazed! "God has shown you all this wisdom!" he said. "I will make you the second most powerful man in all of Egypt. You will be in charge of saving food for the famine!" Joseph went from prison to palace in one day! God's plan was unfolding perfectly.

TIGRINYA:

Frown teginise! "Amlak kulu'za TebebA Arikba!" bele. "Ab kulu Gbtsi KAllay Haylam sebAy kegebrka. Ntsmi meghbi ktzHaw Halafy ktkon!" Yosef kab qeed nab qtsri bHade meAlti keyde! Mdhani Amlak bftstsum yQlel neyru.

(Pronunciation: TebebA = wisdom, Haylam = powerful, qtsri = palace)

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[PICTURE: A watercolor children's Bible illustration showing a time-lapse of Joseph's work — building huge storehouses, gathering mountains of grain during seven good years. Workers fill enormous buildings with wheat and corn. Joseph oversees it all wisely. The land is green and bountiful. Then the scene transitions to show dry, cracked earth during famine — but the storehouses remain full. People line up for food. East African/Eritrean features on Joseph.]

ENGLISH:

For seven years, Joseph wisely saved food in huge storehouses all across Egypt. Then the famine came, just as God said. No rain fell. Nothing grew. People everywhere were hungry — but Egypt had food because of Joseph! People from every country came to Egypt to buy food.

TIGRINYA:

NshbuE Amtat, Yosef bTebbeb meghbi Ab Abi magnetat Ab kulu Gbtsi Azewu. Dhrzi tsmi metse, kmsla Amlak zbele. Znaab AywredeN. Hade nger AybeQleN. Sebat Ab kulu qota jemiEom — Gn Gbtsi bsbe Yosef meghbi neyr'a! Sebat kab kulu Hageratat meghbi kmgzAu nab Gbtsi metsu.

(Pronunciation: magnetat = storehouses, tsmi = famine, meghbi = food)

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[PICTURE: A dramatic watercolor children's Bible illustration of Joseph's ten older brothers arriving in Egypt to buy food. They bow down before Joseph — not recognizing him in his Egyptian royal clothes and gold jewelry! Joseph recognizes them immediately and his eyes fill with emotion. The brothers' faces are pressed to the ground in a grand hall. The dream from childhood has come true! East African/Eritrean features on all.]

ENGLISH:

Then one day, Joseph's own brothers came to Egypt to buy food! They bowed down before Joseph — but they did not recognize him! Joseph had grown up and now wore Egyptian royal clothes. Joseph's childhood dream had come true! His brothers were bowing before him, just as the dream showed.

TIGRINYA:

Dhrzi Hade meAlti, AHwat Yosef btslom meghbi kmgzAu nab Gbtsi metsu! Ab qddmi Yosef sengedwu — gn AyfleT'wuN! Yosef Zedige n Hzi nay Gbtsi nay mngsti klbsi ylebs neyru. Nay ntsnEto Hlmi Yosef Haqi kone! AHwatu Ab qddimu ysengedu neyrom, kmsla Hlmi zrAdye.

(Pronunciation: sengedwu = bowed, AyfleT'wuN = they didn't recognize, Hlmi = dream)

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[PICTURE: A deeply emotional watercolor children's Bible illustration of Joseph revealing himself to his brothers. He removes his Egyptian headdress and cries out "I am Joseph!" His brothers stagger back in shock and fear — their faces show terror, guilt, and disbelief. Joseph reaches toward them with tears streaming down his face — not angry tears, but tears of love and forgiveness. The moment is powerful and emotional. East African/Eritrean features on all.]

ENGLISH:

Joseph could not hold back his tears any longer. He cried out, "I am Joseph — your brother! The one you sold to Egypt!" His brothers were terrified! They thought Joseph would punish them. But Joseph's heart was full of love, not anger. He had already forgiven them.

TIGRINYA:

Yosef nbAatu kmHzwom Aykelen. "Ana Yosef eyen — HawKum! ItsI nGbtsi zshtekumni!" bilu bekhaye. AHwatu bhwiti frhywom! Yosef kmqtsAom zble Hasebwom. Gn lbi Yosef bfqri mluE neyru, bHrage zeykone. dk'A qiRuwom neyru.

(Pronunciation: HawKum = your brother, frhywom = they were terrified, qiRuwom = forgave them)

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[PICTURE: A beautiful watercolor children's Bible illustration of Joseph hugging his brothers warmly. All of them weep together — tears of relief, forgiveness, and reunion. Joseph embraces his youngest brother Benjamin especially tight. In the background, old father Jacob arrives in Egypt on a cart — alive and overjoyed! The whole family is reunited. Golden light pours over the reunion scene like God's blessing. East African/Eritrean features on all.]

ENGLISH:

Joseph hugged each brother and said the most beautiful words: "Do not be afraid! You meant to hurt me, but God used it for good — to save many lives!" Joseph brought his whole family to Egypt. Father Jacob was alive and overjoyed to see his son! The family was together again!

TIGRINYA:

Yosef nkulu Hawu HqifwuN mrmr qal bele: "AytfrHu! KtgdAuni deliKum, Gn Amlak nTsbuQ nger — bluy Hyiwet kAdHn — teQemiwu!" Yosef nmluE sdra betu nab Gbtsi Amtsi'wom. Ab'ye Yaaqob bHywet neyru n wdu krdAi bHage Hagisu! Sdra bet dbritn Hade kone!

(Pronunciation: AytfrHu = don't be afraid, kAdHn = to save, HqifwuN = hugged them)

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[PICTURE: A warm watercolor children's Bible illustration showing two East African/Eritrean children on a playground — one has just been hurt by the other (maybe pushed off a swing). The hurt child, instead of being angry, offers a hand to help the other child up who now looks sorry. A golden heart glows between them. The scene shows choosing forgiveness over anger. Bright school yard colors.]

ENGLISH:

Joseph could have been angry at his brothers forever. They were so mean to him! But Joseph chose forgiveness instead. Forgiveness means letting go of anger and choosing love. When someone hurts you, it is hard — but forgiving them sets YOUR heart free!

TIGRINYA:

Yosef nZIAlem Ab AHwatu kmHrq ykEl neyru. Bhwti Hfuran gir'wuN! Gn Yosef yqret meritsu. Yqret Hrage mHdag n fqri mmrats ybil. Hade sebAy mskgdeAka, kyblx eyu — gn mqRAi NLBKA Harar ygbro!

(Pronunciation: yqret = forgiveness, Hrage = anger, Harar = free)

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[PICTURE: A watercolor children's Bible illustration showing an East African/Eritrean child going through a difficult time — sitting alone while it rains outside. But then the scene transitions to show the same child later, surrounded by friends and sunshine, with something wonderful happening. The message: hard times don't last forever. God can turn bad situations into good ones. Split-panel watercolor style.]

ENGLISH:

Joseph's life was very hard for many years — sold by his brothers, made a slave, thrown in prison. But God was working through every hard time! God turned every bad thing into something good. If you are going through something hard right now, trust that God has a plan!

TIGRINYA:

Hywet Yosef nbluy Amtat bhwti kbdA neyre — bAHwatu tsheyTu, bAriya kone, Ab qeed Atiywu. Gn Amlak Ab kulu kbuD gzie yserH neyru! Amlak nkulu Hfur nger nab TsbuQ qeyer'u. Hzi kbuD nger thAlf mskzleka, Amlak mdhani khlwu AmniKa!

(Pronunciation: kbdA = hard, mdhani = plan, qeyer'u = turned it)

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[PICTURE: A serene watercolor children's Bible illustration of an East African/Eritrean child sitting with a sibling or friend after a disagreement. They have been fighting but now one says "I'm sorry" and the other says "I forgive you." Their hands reach toward each other to make up. A warm golden glow connects them. A Bible sits open nearby. The room feels peaceful again after the storm of anger passes.]

ENGLISH:

Is there someone you need to forgive? A brother, sister, or friend who hurt your feelings? It is not easy, but God will help you. Holding onto anger makes your heart heavy and sad. But when you forgive, your heart becomes light and free — just like Joseph's heart was free!

TIGRINYA:

Ktqro zdeliyeKa Hade sebAy Aldiya? Haw, Hfti, wey AmAli smAAAtKa zgedAe? QelAl Aykon, gn Amlak kHagezeKha eyu. Hrage mHaz lbKha kbudn Hzintn ygbro. Gn mskttqri, lbKha QluIN HarirN ykwn — kmsla lbi Yosef Harir zkone!

(Pronunciation: ktqro = to forgive, smAAAtKa = your feelings, Harir = free)

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[PICTURE: A colorful watercolor children's Bible illustration of East African/Eritrean children holding hands in a circle, each wearing a different bright color — like Joseph's colorful coat spread among them all. They smile at each other with love and forgiveness. Above them, a watercolor rainbow and golden light shine. A dove flies overhead. The scene represents unity, forgiveness, and God's beautiful plan for each child.]

ENGLISH:

Let us pray together! Dear God, thank You for the story of Joseph. Thank You that You can take hard things and make them good. Help us to forgive like Joseph did. Help us to trust Your plan even when things are hard. Thank You for never leaving us alone. We love You! Amen.

TIGRINYA:

Bhmakha ntseluy! Fqur Amlak, nzAntA Yosef neAmsgn. Kbudat ngeratat wesidka TsbuQ kmgbar kmsla ztKel neAmsgn. KmsIa Yosef kmqRAi HarAina. Ngeratat mskykbdu mdhanika kntAmn HarAina. Ftstsum brHuqna sle ztAyHadgna neAmsgn. NfteweKha ina! Amen.

(Pronunciation: ntseluy = let us pray, kmqRAi = to forgive, NfteweKha = we love You)

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[PICTURE: A radiant watercolor children's Bible illustration of a single East African/Eritrean child wearing a bright, colorful outfit (echoing Joseph's coat). The child spreads their arms wide with a joyful, forgiving smile. One hand reaches back (letting go of the past) and the other reaches forward (toward a bright future). Golden light and watercolor hearts surround the child. The background shows a sunrise — new beginnings. The image radiates hope, forgiveness, and God's beautiful plan.]

ENGLISH:

Always remember: God has a BEAUTIFUL plan for YOUR life! Even when hard things happen, God is working everything together for good. Like Joseph, choose to forgive. Like Joseph, trust God even when you cannot see the ending. YOUR story is not over — the best is yet to come!

TIGRINYA:

Kulu gize zeKr: Amlak MRMR mdhani nHYWETKA Alo! Dk'A kbudat ngeratat mskykwnu, Amlak kulu nger nab TsbuQ yserhu Alo. KmsIa Yosef, yqret mrits. KmsIa Yosef, mewedsAta mskAytrAi dk'A nAmlak AmniKa. ZANTAKA gna AywerdeN — nHanay zysbl gna ymetse!

(Pronunciation: mdhani = plan, yqret = forgiveness, ZANTAKA = your story)

The Moral

tmhrti

ENGLISH: God can turn even the worst situations into something beautiful. Like Joseph, we should choose forgiveness over anger, trust over fear, and faithfulness over bitterness. Hard times do not mean God has forgotten us — He is always working behind the scenes for our good. Forgiveness sets our hearts free and allows God's love to flow through us to others.

TIGRINYA: Amlak dk'A nzAbll Hfur kunetat nab mrmr nger kqyer ykEl. KmsIa Yosef, kab Hrage yqret, kab frhit tmHnt, n kab mtsirarr Emnet kmmrits Alena. Kbudat gzeyat Amlak rsA'ina ybil Aykonon — kulu gize nTsbuQna Ab dHri ysrhH Alo. Yqret nlbna Harir ygbro n fqri Amlak bAtna nab Kalot kflfl yeKElo.

Bible Verse

tqsi metsHaf qddus

ENGLISH: "You intended to harm me, but God intended it for good, to accomplish what is now being done, the saving of many lives."
— Genesis 50:20

TIGRINYA: "NsKatkum Hfur HsibKum, gn Amlak nTsbuQ Hsbwu, Hzi ztgber zlo kmgbar, bluy Hyiwet kAdHn."
— Beresi 50:20

Talk About It

bzaEba'zi tezarebu

1. ENGLISH: Why were Joseph's brothers jealous of him? Was their jealousy fair?

TIGRINYA: AHwat Yosef slemntay QnA'om? QunAEom Ftuhawy diya?

2. ENGLISH: Joseph went through many hard times. How did God help him in each one?

TIGRINYA: Yosef bluy kbudat gzeyat Halife. Amlak Ab kulu Hade knedayday Hagizwu?

3. ENGLISH: Why did Joseph forgive his brothers? Would that have been hard for you?

TIGRINYA: Yosef slemntay nAHwatu qeRiOM? NsiKa kyblx dimyu?

4. ENGLISH: Is there someone you need to forgive? How can you show them kindness today?

TIGRINYA: Ktqri zdeliyeKa Hade sebAy Aldiya? Hadi knedayday Hyanet ktrAdyom tkhl?

Prayer

tseLOT

ENGLISH: Dear God, thank You for the story of Joseph and forgiveness. Thank You that You never waste our pain — You use everything for good. Help me to forgive people who hurt me, even when it is hard. Help me to trust Your plan for my life, even when I cannot see what is coming. Fill my heart with love instead of anger. Make my story beautiful like Joseph's. In Jesus' name, Amen.

TIGRINYA: Fqur Amlak, nzAntA Yosef n yqret neAmsgn. Qayye Hywetna ftstsum kemzAytnwo — nkulu nger nTsbuQ ksertHo neAmsgn. ZgdAuni sebat ktqri HarAini dk'A kyblx entymkonu. Mntay kmmetse mskAyflTeNi nmdHanika AmneKha HarAini. Kab Hrage bfqri lbey melAI. KmsIa Yosef zAntAye mrmr grA. BsMe IyeSus, Amen.

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